

INVESTMENT OBJECTIVE AND THE NEED IT ADDRESSES

Theme: global real capacity. The infrastructure growth has to run on. Power, hospital beds, ports, mobile towers, fibre, and the equipment makers and platforms that build and earn from them. A global theme rather than a bet on one country, and deliberately not a technology fund.

Objective. Long-term capital growth from a globally diversified portfolio of companies that own, build or supply long-lived physical and network capacity, with 30% held in Philippine issuers by rule. One pooled fund with a single share price, making no promise about any individual investor's goal date.

The need. A Filipino aged 18 to 25 has two assets: a peso salary and peso goals. Both depend on the same economy, and every product within reach deepens that dependence. BPI's own Philippine Equity Index Fund returned **0.52% a year** over five years after fees, and the closest thing to a global answer on the shelf is a fund that buys other funds, charging a second layer of fees and finishing **4.19 points a year behind the world index it targets**. What is missing here is a **peso-priced global growth fund, holding shares directly, that someone with ₱100 can actually buy**.

Why the risk level is what it is. A young investor puts money in every month rather than taking it out. We shuffled the Fund's 60 monthly returns 20,000 times, which changes the path but never the total. A weak first half made the monthly contributor **richer** and the person drawing down **poorer** (correlations of -0.85 and +0.85), because someone paying in buys more units while prices are low. The retail risk framework here is built to protect a balance, which is the right question for a retiree and the wrong one for this investor.

How a dated goal actually gets funded. The Fund is one half of the journey. The other half is an **account-level glidepath**: from 24 months out, a monthly transfer moves the balance into a money market fund, leaving 15% here on the date. One share price cannot move to safety on dates that differ for every investor, so the rule sits on the account. Goals under five years are declined at sign-up, with a reason.

KEY FACTS

Theme	Global real capacity
Fund structure	Single pooled fund, unitized
Classification	Aggressive
Minimum initial	₱100
Contribution rails	Payday schedule · Sukli · top-up
Minimum recurring	₱100 / month
Recommended horizon	5 years and above
Currency	Philippine peso
Holdings	16 direct securities
Management fee	1.50% p.a.
Liquid reserve	9.98% (Rule 6.10)
Single-issuer cap	10.0% (Rule 6)
Weighting method	Equal risk contribution
Benchmark	MSCI ACWI, in PHP
Valuation	Daily, NAVPS

How holdings are sized. Each one is set to add about the same amount of risk to the portfolio, judged by how the sixteen move together rather than how each moves alone. Our opinion of a company plays no part. In practice each contributes between 5.95% and 6.62% of total risk, against a 6.25% target.

PERFORMANCE · SIMULATED, AFTER THE 1.50% FEE · 9 AUG 2021 TO 10 AUG 2026

11.77% Volatility p.a. vs 18.19% index	0.37 Beta to MSCI ACWI	-17.23% Maximum drawdown ₱862 on ₱5,000	1.01 Sharpe ratio vs 0.56 index	17.14% Return p.a., net vs 15.41% index
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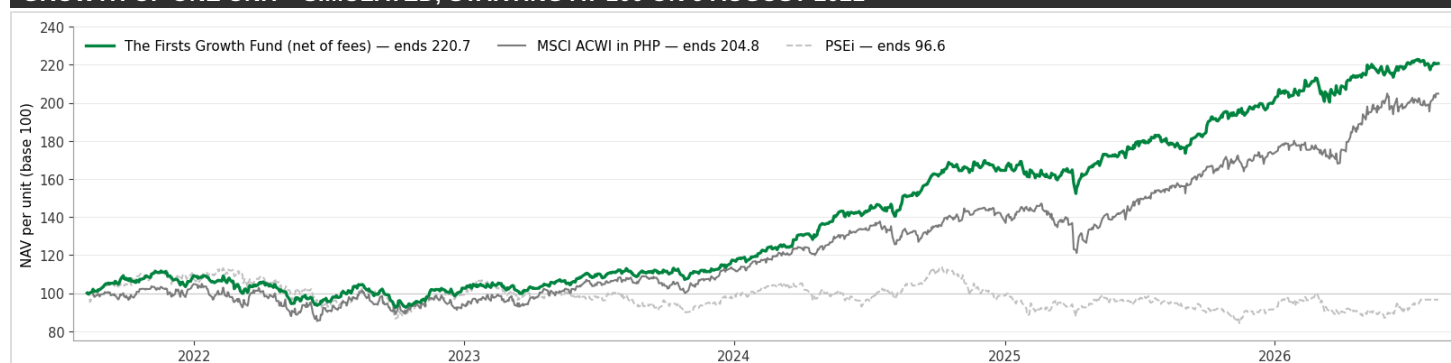
We put risk before return here on purpose. The return figure is the least reliable number on this page. See How to read the back-test on page 2.

Calendar year	Fund	MSCI ACWI (PHP)	Risk statistic	Fund	Index
2021 (from 9 Aug)	+9.22%	+4.77%	Volatility p.a.	11.77%	18.19%
2022	-5.53%	-9.86%	Downside deviation	7.97%	n/a
2023	+14.47%	+21.29%	Sharpe ratio	1.01	0.56
2024	+40.46%	+25.60%	Sortino ratio	1.49	n/a
2025	+21.39%	+26.40%	Maximum drawdown	-17.23%	-18.71%
2026 (to 10 Aug)	+8.77%	+17.67%	Worst rolling 12 months	-15.35%	n/a
1 year	+20.46%	+32.21%	Best rolling 12 months	+54.71%	n/a
3 years p.a.	+25.25%	+23.82%	12-month periods positive	84%	n/a
5 years p.a.	+17.14%	+15.41%	Beta / correlation	0.37 / 0.58	n/a
			Excess return over the index, geometric	+1.50%	n/a

The Fund lost to the index over the last twelve months by 11.74 points, and in three of the five calendar years shown. A portfolio that moves less than the market lags a rising one, and that same property produced the shallower fall.

The same risks in pesos, for someone paying **₱1,000 a month**. The 17.23% worst fall on a ₱5,000 balance is **₱862**, or about four weeks of contributions. The worst twelve months, 15.35%, is **₱767**. A 22-year-old does not experience risk as a percentage, so we publish both. **Reading the table:** volatility and downside deviation measure how much the value swings, the second counting only falls. Sharpe and Sortino measure return earned per unit of risk, so higher is better. Beta 0.37 means the Fund moved about a third as much as world markets.

GROWTH OF ONE UNIT · SIMULATED, STARTING AT 100 ON 9 AUGUST 2021



Hypothetical. Built by applying the Fund's published selection rules and limits to historical prices. The Fund does not exist and has no live track record.

IMPORTANT. All figures are **simulated**, prepared with hindsight. Not an offer or investment advice and not a BPI Wealth product; full disclosures on page 1. **Sources:** Yahoo Finance, PSE exports, iShares ACWI, PSEi, BSP, PSA, and BPI and Pag-IBIG disclosure statements. GICS sectors assigned by the team.

TOP TEN HOLDINGS · WEIGHT AND SHARE OF PORTFOLIO RISK					GEOGRAPHIC		SECTOR · GICS	
Holding	Role	Mkt	Weight	% of risk				
IHH Healthcare	Owner	SG	9.39%	5.96%	Philippines	30.01%	Utilities	27.65%
DBS Group	Platform	SG	8.15%	6.19%	Singapore	29.74%	Industrials	15.86%
Iberdrola	Owner	ES	8.01%	5.95%	India	11.36%	Health Care	15.80%
Meralco	Owner	PH	7.58%	6.61%	Spain	8.01%	Comm. Services	9.78%
Sembcorp Industries	Owner	SG	6.70%	5.96%	France	4.36%	Financials	8.15%
Apollo Hospitals	Owner	IN	6.41%	5.95%	Taiwan	4.04%	Cons. Staples	6.27%
Century Pacific Food	Owner	PH	6.27%	6.61%	United States	2.50%	Info. Technology	4.04%
ICTSI	Owner	PH	5.97%	6.61%	Reserve	9.98%	Cons. Discretionary	2.47%
ACEN	Owner	PH	5.36%	6.60%				
Indus Towers	Owner	IN	4.95%	5.95%				

Top ten 68.79% 62.41%

The remaining six. Converge ICT Owner, PH 4.83% · Schneider Electric Supplier, FR 4.36% · TSMC Supplier, TW 4.04% · Grab Holdings Platform, SG 3.03% · Vertiv Supplier, US 2.50% · Sea Limited Platform, SG 2.47%. Sub-total 21.23%. **Asset allocation: equities 90.02%, liquid reserve 9.98%. The right-hand column is deliberately flat.** Weights range from 2.47% to 9.39% while each holding's share of risk sits between 5.95% and 6.62%. Vertiv gets 2.50% of the money because its price swings about 66% a year; IHH gets 9.39% because its swings about 22%.

THE RULES THE PORTFOLIO MUST OBEY · ALL MET AT ONCE			HOW WE PICKED THE SIXTEEN · THREE STEPS, IN ORDER		HOW THIS FUND COMPARES		
Limit	Rule	Actual			Fund	Min.	5-yr p.a.
Owners	≥ 45%	65.47%	M Map the milestone. Identify what drives the cost of the first being funded (housing, transport, education, travel, or starting a business), and therefore what the portfolio needs to own.		BPI Global Equity Fund-of-Funds	₱1,000	7.15%
Suppliers	≤ 25%	10.90%	V Verify the investment. Pass or fail on current disclosures. Each holding is classified by <i>what pays it</i> : an Owner is paid for the use of capacity for decades after the build, a Supplier during the build, a Platform on end demand. The company must have published a capacity target with a number and a date. On debt we require net debt no higher than 4.0 times annual earnings and profits covering interest at least 2.5 times, with regulated utilities allowed 6.0 times under four published conditions. Price is pass or fail, not a score.		Fund-of-funds, 11 target funds, MSCI ACWI benchmark, 1.50% plus target fund fees		
Platforms	≤ 20%	13.65%	P Position the risk. Only after V. Each holding is sized to add roughly the same amount of risk to the portfolio, using how the sixteen move together rather than how each moves alone, then checked against the rules above. Our own opinion of a company plays no part: moving every opinion score by 10 points either way changed the annual return by less than one point.		BPI Philippine Equity Index Fund	₱1,000	0.52%
Liquid reserve	10%	9.98%	How to read the simulation. We picked these sixteen in 2026 and applied our rules to their past prices, so it tests the method rather than our stock-picking. <i>The six biases, their direction and our estimate of their size: Annex A4.</i>		Passive, 32 PSEi names, 1.50%		
Single issuer	≤ 10%	9.39%			Pag-IBIG MP2	₱500	7.1%
Single group	≤ 15%	5.36%			Government savings. Tax-free, and it has never had a losing year		
Philippines	30% ±3	30.01%			The Firsts Fund	₱100	17.14% simulated

No holding sits at its cap, and every weight came out of the risk model rather than being cut down to fit a limit. **There is no GICS sector cap.** Sector weights are an output of the role limits and the risk model, with Utilities largest at 27.65%. We disclose that rather than constrain it, on the same basis as the concentration note below.

Where the fund is still concentrated. The sixteen behave like roughly **4.8 independent bets**, and two shared forces carry **71.3%** of the risk: a global growth and technology-building cycle, and a Philippine and Asian infrastructure cycle. Down from 94.1% under our earlier method, and still the largest risk we have not removed.

THE MAIN RISKS, AND WHAT WE DO ABOUT EACH		CLIENT SUITABILITY	
Risk	How it is managed, and what remains		
Market and equity 90% equities, Aggressive.	9.98% in cash; risk-based sizing keeps any company's share of total risk at 6.62% or below; the Fund moved about a third as much as world markets. Reduced, not removed. Falls near 17% appear in the simulated history and larger ones are possible.	For an investor with a goal five or more years away who can contribute regularly and sit through a fall of about a sixth without stopping. Not for money needed within five years, an emergency fund, or someone who would stop after a bad year. For all three a money market fund is right, and our sign-up screen sends them there.	
Concentration and factor	No more than 10% in one company or 15% in one group, plus limits by role. The largest risk we have not removed. Two shared forces carry 71.3% of the risk, so a slowdown in global infrastructure spending hits several holdings together.	THE TEAM Prince Angelo C. Rivera · Luis Tengonciang · Karol Josef Fuñe · Eric Fabian Thirdy Mendez Team Los Angeles 76ers. All four study BS Applied Mathematics with a Master in Data Science at Ateneo de Manila University, and built the weighting engine, constraint stack, shuffle test and 20,000-path simulations in this proposal in Python.	
Currency, country and liquidity About 70% non-peso.	The currency exposure is left unhedged on purpose : the investor's salary and goals are already entirely in pesos, so hedging back would rebuild the very concentration the Fund exists to offset. Seven listing venues, with no non-Philippine country above 30%. All sixteen are large and traded daily, so the cash reserve meets withdrawals without forced selling.		
Sequence risk near the goal date	From 24 months out a monthly transfer moves the balance into a money market fund. The worst stressed outcome improves from ₱68,855 to ₱77,736 and the gap between best and worst roughly halves, at a typical cost of ₱7,419 . One share price cannot move to safety on dates that differ per investor, so this sits on the account. Exec summary, p3.		

IMPORTANT. All figures are **simulated** and prepared with hindsight. Not an offer or investment advice and not a BPI Wealth product; full disclosures on page 1. The company-by-company checking described above is not complete. **Sources:** Yahoo Finance and PSE exports converted to pesos daily; iShares ACWI for MSCI ACWI; PSEi; BSP and PSA; BPI and Pag-IBIG disclosure statements. GICS sectors assigned by the team.



THE FIRSTS FUND

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY · THE PROBLEM, AND THE FUND THAT ANSWERS IT
FinQuest 2026 · Los Angeles 76ers · Ateneo de Manila University · Page 1 of 3

"There will always be
a new first."

THE PROBLEM WE FOUND, AFTER RULING OUT THE ONE EVERYONE ELSE SOLVES

At 22, your biggest asset is forty years of future earnings. It is paid in pesos, it rises and falls with one economy, and you cannot sell it or insure it. You are already all-in on the Philippines, and you never chose to be.

Now look at what a young Filipino can actually buy. Pag-IBIG MP2 lends their savings to the Philippine government. GFunds buys the local index. BPI's own Philippine Equity Index Fund returned **0.52% a year** over five years after fees. **Every product within reach adds to the bet they already cannot escape.**

Access has improved, so we are not going to claim access is the problem. BPI cut its minimum investment from ₱10,000 to ₱1,000 in 2023. Some platforms now start at ₱50. PSE accounts rose **50.1%** in one year, **26.5%** of them held by 18-to-29-year-olds, and the BSP measures financial literacy rising rather than falling. Young Filipinos have arrived. What has not changed is the shape of the shelf they arrive at. A cautious young client gets offered a savings product, and the middle of the range, where a forty-year horizon belongs, is empty.

"Number one: you have to get global exposure. The S&P 500 companies are actually higher quality than local PSEi names. So by diversifying some of that local exposure, you're actually lowering your volatility."

Joaquin Rossano U. Veluz, Sun Life Investment Management and Trust Co.

WHY WE CAN TAKE THIS MUCH RISK WITH A 22-YEAR-OLD'S MONEY

A retiree takes money out. A 22-year-old puts money in every month, and that reverses which market conditions help them.

We tested it. Take the Fund's 60 monthly returns and shuffle the order 20,000 times. Shuffling changes the path but never the destination: every ordering compounds to exactly the same total. Then run two people through all 20,000 paths.

How much a weak first half changed final wealth

Someone paying in ₱1,000/month	-0.85
Someone taking out ₱900/month	+0.85

Read those as strong relationships in opposite directions. A weak first half made the monthly contributor **richer** and the withdrawer **poorer**, because the person paying in buys more units while prices are low. We checked the same test on 220 months of global market history, including the 2008 crash, and got -0.77 and +0.77.

The same point in pesos. ₱1,000 a month into a money market fund at 4.5% grows to **₱67,238** over five years. The Fund's **worst possible ordering of its own returns** still beats that. Across 20,000 sequences, including the ones we built to hurt a contributor most, **the safe product lost every single time.**

We are not saying falling markets are good. A market that drops and stays down hurts everybody. The narrow claim is this: if you end up in the same place, you would rather have gone down first.

WHAT THAT MEANS FOR THE PRODUCT, AND THE FUND IT PRODUCES

We built for a different goal. Most funds aim to keep the drop small, which suits someone spending their savings. For a monthly contributor, the shuffle test shows that aim costs money. Our goal is to **maximise the chance the investor is still contributing in year five**, because contributions, not returns, decide where a young person lands. Everything in the Hook and the Habit serves that one number.

What the Fund owns. Companies that own, build or supply infrastructure with a long life: power plants, hospitals, ports, mobile towers, fibre networks, and the equipment makers and platforms that serve them. Sixteen companies held **directly**, so investors pay one layer of fees rather than a fund that buys other funds. Thirty percent Philippines by rule. Priced in pesos, ₱100 to start. Each holding is sized so it adds about the same amount of risk as every other holding, which is why the small, jumpy names get small weights. *Full portfolio and process: Fund Fact Sheet.*

We publish risk in pesos. A 22-year-old putting in ₱1,000 a month does not think in percentages. A 17.23% fall on a ₱5,000 balance is **₱862**, or about four weeks of contributions. Every risk figure in this proposal carries its peso equivalent.

17.14%

Return a year,
after the
1.50% fee
(simulated)

11.77%

How much it
moves
vs 18.19% for the
index

0.37

Sensitivity to
world
markets (1.0 =
matches)

-17.23%

Worst fall
₱862 on ₱5,000

1.01

Return per unit of
risk
vs 0.56 for the
index

65%

Held in
infrastructure
owners, the
steady half

Simulated, 9 Aug 2021 to 10 Aug 2026, after fees. These are not a track record. We picked the sixteen companies in 2026 and applied our rules to their past prices, so the test shows whether the method builds a sensible portfolio, not whether we would have picked these names in 2021. The Fund also lost to the index in three of five calendar years and by 11.74 points over the last twelve months. A fund that moves only 0.37 as much as world markets will lag a rising market, and that same property gave it the shallower fall. Method and four stated limitations are in the annex.

HOW THE FUND COMPARES TO WHAT A YOUNG FILIPINO CAN BUY TODAY

Product	What it is	Min.	Fee	5-yr a year	What it still does not solve
BPI Global Equity Fund-of-Funds	A fund that buys 11 other funds	₱1,000	1.50% <i>plus</i> the fees inside those funds	7.15%	It measures itself against the same world index we do, and came in 4.19 points a year behind it over five years. Investors pay two layers of fees. No Philippine holdings.
BPI Philippine Equity Index Fund	Tracks the PSEi, 32 companies	₱1,000	1.50%	0.52%	More of the one bet they cannot escape. A quarter is holding companies and a quarter is banks, with almost no infrastructure.
Pag-IBIG MP2	Government savings programme, tax-free	₱500	None	7.1%	Tax-free and it has never had a losing year, but it lends their savings to the same economy their salary already depends on. After 6.2% inflation, it barely keeps up.
Peso money market fund	Short-term lending	₱50 to ₱1,000	0.5 to 1.0%	4 to 5%	Loses to inflation slowly and reliably.
The Firsts Fund	16 companies held directly	₱100	1.50%, one layer	17.14% simulated	Fills the gap: global infrastructure ownership, priced in pesos, with 30% Philippines.

Compare the structures, not the returns. Ours is simulated and theirs are live, so those two columns are not comparable and we do not present them as if they were. The comparisons that hold without using our return at all are the minimum investment, the number of fee layers, the Philippine weight, and one uncomfortable fact: the product closest to ours buys other funds and finished five years behind the index it targets. That is the practical case for holding shares directly, which is also where the primer's ban on feeder funds points. **Where MP2 beats us, we say so.** For a goal three to five years away it is the better product, and our goal-setting screen sends people there instead of taking their money.

Sources: BPI Global Equity Fund-of-Funds disclosure statement, 29 May 2026; BPI Philippine Equity Index Fund disclosure statement, 30 January 2026; Pag-IBIG 2025 dividend declaration; PSA inflation, July 2026.

THE MESSAGE

Fund your Firsts.

Retirement is the wrong pitch for a 22-year-old. It sits forty years away, it belongs to a person they cannot picture yet, and every competing product already uses it. **A first has a name, a price and a date.** It is the only long-term goal a young Filipino can actually see, and it is why the account never closes: finish one, name the next.

First solo trip

First laptop that's actually yours

First month you covered your own rent

First time you sent money home and still kept some

First business permit

First car down payment

First ₱100,000

Each of these gets entered into the app as a peso figure and a month, which is what turns a feeling into a contribution schedule.

THE MAIN CHANNEL: FINANCE CREATORS YOUNG FILIPINOS ALREADY WATCH

Young Filipinos already learn about money on TikTok and YouTube, from people who explain it in Taglish. The twenty biggest business and finance creators in the Philippines reach roughly **4.5 million people** at an average engagement rate of **5.87%**, which no bank page comes close to. Creators like Nicole Alba, Jax Reyes and Coach Paolo Castro built those audiences by breaking hard topics into short, plain explanations, and banks and investment platforms already work with them.

We would brief them differently from a normal sponsorship. Every partner receives the calculator and the bad-year figure, and the agreement requires them to show both. No price targets, no get-rich framing, no undisclosed placements, and a stated fee so the audience knows what they are watching. A creator who explains what the Fund owns and what a bad year costs is doing our campaign's job in a voice their audience already trusts.

Why this does not contradict our own evidence. Susada (2025) found that pressure from friends and family does not predict whether a young Filipino invests. A creator explaining a product is not peer pressure. They are the reason a beginner believes they can do this competently, which is the one thing that study found *does* predict investing.

THE CAMPAIGN IDEA: WE SHOW YOU THE BAD YEAR FIRST

Every investment product in this market leads with the upside and mentions the downside at the point of sale. **We flip the order, and the flip is the advertisement.** The first thing we build is a calculator, not a film. One screen: name your first, enter what it costs, pick the month. It gives back the monthly contribution you need and, before you sign up for anything, **what a bad year would cost you in pesos on that balance.**

In a category where every competitor sells optimism, the open position is honesty. It costs almost nothing to build, a competitor cannot copy it without abandoning their own campaign, and it does the thing the research says actually moves this group: it makes a beginner feel capable instead of excited.

THE OTHER THREE CHANNELS

BPI payroll accounts

A young Filipino's first job usually comes with a payroll account they did not choose. BPI already banks a large corporate payroll base, so it can reach this group in the month they first earn money, already signed up and already identity-checked. The offer appears on the first salary credit. Almost no cost to acquire.

e-Invest

BPI Wealth's existing digital sign-up platform, built for first-time investors. The rails are live and nothing here needs a new build.

GCash and Maya

94 million and 50 million users. The Philippines is the only ASEAN country where more people open an e-wallet each month than a banking app, and this competition's own primer puts e-wallet use at 58% of Filipino adults. This is where the money comes in. See Sukli on page 3.

Campus and first-job

Finance and business organisations, plus graduate-hire onboarding at partner employers. We bring the calculator and the bad-year figure, not branded merchandise.

The launch date does work too. December, when 13th month pay lands. It is required by law, everyone gets it on the same schedule, and it is the one month a young worker holds money that was never in a budget. **"Your 13th month is the only money you were never budgeting. Give it a first."** December opens the account and January turns it into a habit.

THE COMMERCIAL QUESTION A ₱100 MINIMUM INVITES, ANSWERED BEFORE IT IS ASKED

A ₱100 balance at a 1.50% fee earns ₱1.50 a year, which pays for nothing. We are not going to pretend otherwise. This product does not make money on the opening deposit. It makes money on the flow of contributions afterwards, and the whole design points at that.

An account putting in ₱1,000 a month plus roughly ₱300 of Sukli reaches about ₱16,000 in year one and roughly ₱90,000 by year five on the simulated path, worth about **₱1,350 a year in fees per mature account.** What decides whether this works is not how many accounts open. It is **what share are still contributing in month sixty**, the same number the Fund's investment objective is written around.

Three assumptions we are flagging rather than hiding. Acquisition cost is close to zero inside the existing payroll and customer base but not on creator, wallet or campus channels. Holding sixteen companies directly across seven markets carries real custody, currency and audit cost that a ₱1.50-a-year account cannot cover, so the Fund needs seed capital and a minimum size before it opens. None of this is a costed model yet. It is the shape of one, and the first thing we would build with real numbers.

FIVE REASONS THEY DON'T START, AND WHAT REMOVES EACH

"I don't have enough"	₱100 to open, ₱100 a month, and Sukli, for money they were not counting.
"I don't know what I'm buying"	Sixteen named companies with a stated job. Not a fund that buys other funds.
"I'll lose it"	The peso cost of a bad year, shown before sign-up instead of after.
"I'll need it back"	Goals under five years are declined and sent to MP2 or a money market fund.
"I stopped and never restarted"	Contributions run on payday. A missed month prompts and closes nothing.

THE FIRST THING WE BUILD · ONE SCREEN, AND THE ORDER IT PUTS THINGS IN

FUND YOUR FIRSTS · WHAT WILL YOURS COST?

What is it?

Siargao, first solo trip

What does it cost, and when?

₱26,000 · June 2029

PUT IN EVERY MONTH

₱662 for 35 months, or start at ₱100

AND IF YOUR FIRST YEAR IS A BAD ONE

–₱1,366 on the ₱7,944 you would have paid in by then

Our worst year takes that much off, about **two months of contributions.** Keep paying in and Siargao is still on time.

Start with ₱100

Read the order, because the order is the whole idea. The number a young Filipino needs comes first. The number that scares them comes second, in pesos, on their own balance, before they have given us a peso or a piece of personal information. Every other product in this market does it the other way round.

The bad-year figure is small on purpose. It is small because their balance is small, and that is what we want a 22-year-old to absorb early. A 17.2% fall sounds frightening and costs ₱1,366, which two months of contributions makes back. Someone who learns that in year one is far less likely to sell in year two, and selling is the one behaviour that decides whether they reach the goal.

The screen assumes 8% a year, about half the Fund's simulated figure, and uses our worst real fall rather than an average one. **It is also the creator brief:** partners run their own first through it on camera, then sit with the red number.



WHERE THIS LIVES: BPI HOLDS THE ACCOUNT, THE WALLET COLLECTS THE MONEY

Why BPI holds the account. The investor is already signed up and identity-checked, so opening is a confirmation instead of an application. Their salary lands here, which makes payday a natural trigger. Suitability, statements and the redemption screen stay under one regulated roof. The glidepath needs two funds, a growth fund and a money market fund, and BPI runs both. **Nothing in this design needs a product that does not exist.**

Why the wallet collects the money. GCash has 94 million users and Maya 50 million. The Philippines is the only ASEAN country where more people use an e-wallet each month than a banking app, and this competition's own primer puts e-wallet use at **58% of Filipino adults**. A fund that wants a contribution every month should collect it where the taps already happen.

THE LOOP

- 1 Name the first, set the date.** Under five years is declined, with a reason.
- 2 Fund it three ways.** Payday, Sukli, top-ups. Any one alone is enough.
- 3 See risk in pesos** before it happens.
- 4 Move to safety on a schedule** from 24 months out.
- 5 Then name the next one.** The account reopens instead of closing.

SUKLI: TURNING THE THING THEY DO MOST OFTEN INTO THE THING THE FUND NEEDS

Sukli is the change you get back from a purchase, a word every Filipino has used since they were seven. Switch it on once and every discretionary payment in GCash or Maya rounds up to the nearest ₱20. The difference goes to one side, and at ₱100 it moves into the Fund. A ₱137 milk tea becomes ₱140 and ₱3 goes to your first. Nobody feels ₱3. At roughly **30 discretionary wallet payments a month**, our assumption rather than a measured figure, that is about **₱300 a month from money nobody was budgeting**, on top of payday.

Why this suits this fund. Our goal is to keep the investor contributing to year five. A monthly contribution is a monthly decision, and every decision is a chance to stop. Sukli takes the decision away without taking the control away, so it helps people keep a commitment they already made rather than talking them into a new one. That is why it sits comfortably beside our refusal to use referral bonuses and leaderboards.

The obvious objection. A round-up must never become a reason to spend. So Sukli is capped, it takes a slice of spending already happening, the app never suggests or celebrates a purchase, and payday stays the main way money comes in. Sukli is the backup that survives the months when discipline does not.

How it works

Rounds up to the nearest ₱20, or takes 1 to 5% of the payment if you prefer

Applies to

Spending only. Never to cash-in, sending money, bills or remittances received

Safety limits

Nothing is taken below a ₱500 wallet balance. Monthly cap set by you, ₱1,000 by default

Where it waits

In a money market fund, so it earns while it waits. Moves into the Fund at ₱100

Turning it off

One tap. No lock-in, no penalty

Two details that matter more than they look. Waiting money sits in a money market fund rather than a zero-interest balance, so it keeps earning, and the wallet totals everything up and sends BPI Wealth one payment a day, so the Fund handles one daily transaction instead of a million ₱100 ones.

FIVE PRODUCT RULES: WE DESIGN AGAINST DAILY ENGAGEMENT

Every consumer app in this category chases daily active users. A fund built on keeping people contributing should chase the opposite, because checking your balance is what comes before selling. Rules we would hold ourselves to.

- 1** No daily balance notification, ever.
- 2** The headline number is **months funded**, not percentage change.
- 3** Notifications follow payday and your goal date, never the market.
- 4** Checking your balance takes one more tap than adding to it.
- 5** The months-funded counter **only goes up**. A missed month pauses it and nothing resets, because a streak you can break gives people a reason to quit.

Signing up takes four screens. Confirm who you are from the existing BPI record, name your first and its date, see the contribution you need next to the bad year in pesos, then set the payday amount and switch on Sukli. No paperwork, no branch, no new identity check. **The main screen shows three things and nothing else:** months funded, pesos still needed, and the sixteen companies you own by name and job.

"What do I actually own" is the question a fund that buys other funds cannot answer.

THE REDEMPTION SCREEN, WHERE FUNDS ACTUALLY LOSE PEOPLE

A young investor who sells in month fourteen was failed by the one screen nobody bothers to design, not by the portfolio. This is ours.

WITHDRAW · CONFIRM

₱4,138

That is **14 months of contributions**, and it leaves you **₱21,860 short** of your first: *Siargao, June 2029*.

One thing worth knowing first. You are down 9.4% and you are still paying in every month. In our testing, someone who keeps contributing through a weak stretch finishes **ahead** of someone who does not, because the monthly payments buy more units while prices are low. Selling is the one version where that stops working for you.

Pause contributions for 3 months instead

Withdraw ₱4,138

Pausing beats withdrawing, and the screen should say so. We offer the pause first: the account stays open, the units stay invested, the schedule restarts without signing up again. Withdrawing stays one tap away, because **we are not proposing friction that traps people's money**. Only that the cheaper option comes first, and that the loss gets counted in months, since months are what they actually spent.

HOW WE WOULD KNOW IF THIS WORKED, AND THE NUMBERS WE WOULD BE HELD TO

What we measure	Target	We would call it a failure	What we would refuse to call success: money gathered, accounts opened, daily active users or app sessions. All four can rise while the Fund fails at its actual job. The first two above would tell us to lower the risk level.
Still contributing in month 60	55% or more	Under 40%	The glidepath closes the loop. As the goal date approaches the investor stops paying in and starts taking out, so the balance becomes what matters and the relationship flips from -0.85 to +0.85 . From 24 months out a fixed monthly transfer moves the balance into a money market fund. In testing it lifts the worst stressed outcome from ₱68,855 to ₱77,736 , roughly halves the spread of outcomes, and wins in 100% of stressed paths, at a typical cost of ₱7,419 . One share price cannot move to safety on dates that differ for every investor, so this is an account rule between two funds BPI already runs. <i>Figures: Fact Sheet, p2.</i>
Kept contributing through the first bad quarter	80% unchanged	Under 60%	
People who pause for every one who withdraws	3 to 1	Under 1 to 1	
Accounts using Sukli by month 6	40% or more	Under 15%	
Months funded per account in year one	10 of 12	Under 7	

IMPORTANT. A hypothetical student proposal for FinQuest 2026, not an offer or investment advice and not a BPI Wealth product. All performance is **simulated**. Sukli would need e-money partner agreements, written user permission for recurring debits and regulatory review, none of which has been obtained. Full disclosures: Fund Fact Sheet and annex.



THE FIRSTS FUND

ANNEX · EVIDENCE, METHOD, LIMITATIONS AND REGULATORY POSITION
FinQuest 2026 · Los Angeles 76ers · Ateneo de Manila University · Annex

*"There will always be
a new first."*

A1 · EVERY CLAIM THIS PROPOSAL RESTS ON, AND WHERE IT CAME FROM

Claim	Figure	Source
Young Filipinos are already investing, in growing numbers, and are not rich	18 to 29-year-olds hold 26.5% of PSE accounts, up from 19.5%; investors earning under ₱500k a year hold 82.4%, up from 70.9%	PSE 2024 investor profile, via Manila Bulletin (2025)
Access and literacy have both improved, so neither is the blocker	BPI minimum cut from ₱10,000 to ₱1,000 in 2023; PSE accounts up 50.1% in a year; 74% answered half the literacy questions correctly, up from 69%	BPI Wealth; PSE; BSP 2025
The industry answers caution with cash, cash loses to inflation, and the local market has been the weak bet	About 90% of Sun Life's fund assets sit in money market products; inflation was 6.2% in July 2026; BPI's Philippine Equity Index Fund returned 0.52% a year after fees and the PSEi fell 7.3% in 2025 while the S&P 500 rose 22.6%	BusinessWorld (2026); PSA; BPI disclosure statement, Jan 2026; PSE; S&P
The closest existing global product came in behind its own benchmark	BPI Global Equity Fund-of-Funds returned 7.15% a year against the index's 11.34% over five years, with a second fee layer disclosed	BPI disclosure statement, 29 May 2026
The wallet is where the money moves, and creators are where the learning happens	GCash 94M users, Maya 50M; the only ASEAN country where monthly e-wallet use exceeds banking app use; 58% of adults use one; the top 20 business and finance creators reach about 4.5M people at 5.87% engagement	Company disclosures; BSP (2026), cited in the FinQuest 2026 primer; influData, Feb 2026
Feeling capable, not peer pressure, predicts investing	Belief in one's own ability scored $\beta = 0.502$, $p < .001$. Pressure from friends and family scored $r = 0.09$, $p = .213$, which is no relationship at all	Susada (2025), 191 respondents

We withdrew three claims from an earlier draft after checking them: that the suitability questionnaire is the real barrier, that young Filipinos quit after one bad experience, and that 18 to 25-year-olds are moderately aggressive investors. None appears in this submission. **No Philippine study measures risk tolerance directly in this age group.** Every source above measures intention, literacy, participation or behaviour, and we do not claim otherwise.

A2 · IDEAS WE DROPPED, AND WHY

Three claims we could not source	That the suitability questionnaire is the barrier (access clearly improved over the same period), that young Filipinos quit after one bad experience (no source, and the shuffle test shows the reasoning runs backwards for a monthly contributor), and that 18 to 25s are moderately aggressive (never found, never published).
Referral bonuses and social proof	Susada (2025) found no relationship, $r = 0.09$. We kept creator reach, which explains, and dropped peer pressure, which persuades.
Unlocking a riskier fund by passing a quiz	Education can build understanding. It cannot change how much loss a person can actually absorb.
Streaks that reset	A counter you can break gives people a reason to quit in month four.

A3 · WHERE THE SUITABILITY QUESTIONNAIRE ACTUALLY SITS

We are not asking BPI to weaken a control that protects investors. **The questionnaire is measuring the wrong client.** It asks how much of a *balance* you can afford to lose, when for a 22-year-old the number that decides the outcome is how much they will *contribute*, every month, for how many years. Suitability work normally separates how much loss someone can absorb, how much they can stomach, and how much they need to take. A forty-year horizon belongs in the first, and the form underweights it.

What we propose instead of a workaround: record the goal date in the suitability file and let the account-level glidepath bring risk down as that date approaches. **Our own position, honestly:** if the questionnaire blocks a young contributor that supports this argument, and if it does not, the argument still holds, because the point was never that the form blocks people but that it asks a spending question of someone who is saving.

A5 · REGULATORY POSITION, INCLUDING SUKLI

The Fund. A peso fund holding foreign shares directly, 10% cap per company, 10% in cash, matching our reading of Investment Company Act rules 6 and 6.10. **No lawyer and no regulator has reviewed that reading,** and anyone taking this forward would need to.

Sukli. Rounding up a payment every time someone spends requires written, itemised permission the user can withdraw, an agreement with GCash or Maya, and treatment of the waiting balance under BSP e-money rules. **We assume none of that exists yet.** The design choices anticipating that review are on page 3: spending only, a ₱500 floor, a user-set cap, one tap to switch off, and money that waits inside a regulated fund rather than a distributor's float.

We are not asking for a weaker suitability assessment, a quiz that overrides it, or permission to sell an aggressive product to someone rated conservative. **Governance we would expect:** trust committee approval of any revised model, a record of the goal date, and a log of any override.

A4 · HOW WE BUILT THE SIMULATION, AND WHAT IT CANNOT TELL YOU

Method. 1,306 daily prices, 9 August 2021 to 10 August 2026, all converted to pesos at daily exchange rates. We solved for weights that give every holding the same share of portfolio risk, using how the sixteen move together rather than how each one moves on its own, then applied the limits published on the fact sheet. Rebalanced quarterly, with weights left to drift in between. All figures are after the 1.50% fee. The benchmark is the MSCI All Country World Index in pesos, rebuilt from iShares ACWI values and dividends.

Look-ahead in the risk model We solved the weights on covariance measured over the whole five years, so both the price swings *and the way the sixteen move together* use data a real manager would not have had at each rebalancing date. Correlations are where this kind of model gets most of its edge, so this is **the largest of the biases** and it flatters the result.

We chose the companies knowing the answer Picked in 2026, priced backwards. The test shows the method builds a sensible portfolio, not that we would have picked these sixteen in 2021.

Survivorship in the universe Every candidate still exists, trades and is liquid in 2026. Companies that looked like plausible capacity owners in 2021 and have since been delisted, acquired or written down could never have entered our list.

The five years were not uniform 7.96% a year in the first half against 27.02% in the second. The second half was the artificial intelligence building boom, which is where the Fund's biggest shared risk sits.

Two that work against us The five PSE names carry price only, without dividends, while the overseas holdings include them. And we rebuilt MSCI ACWI from iShares ACWI values, which carry that fund's own costs, so the benchmark is slightly understated. Neither is corrected.

Sizing them, rather than only naming them. The missing Philippine dividends understate the reported return by roughly **70 basis points a year** (a 30% sleeve against a PSEi yield near 2.35%). Dividend withholding across seven tax jurisdictions, dealing spreads and currency conversion on quarterly rebalancing would take off something in the order of **50 to 130 basis points**, and at 65% infrastructure owners this portfolio pays a lot of dividends. The look-ahead in the risk model is the largest term and we cannot size it without re-solving on trailing data. **Netting those, the true figure sits below 17.14%, and we would not defend the reported number to the basis point.** Re-solving on a rolling 24-month covariance is the first analysis we would run next.

A6 · WHAT WOULD CHANGE OUR MIND

The shuffle result is arithmetic and holds whatever the simulation says. The product case rests on something we cannot verify: that a young investor keeps contributing for 60 straight months, which no source measures for this group. **If real continuity is much worse than we assume, the risk level should come down.** Sukli raises continuity without relying on the investor's discipline, but its take-up and whether it survives a falling market are unmeasured too. Those are the first two things we would test with real data, and together they are the weak point of this submission.